USER GUIDE

FoodPrint

Canteen Billing App — Cashier Guide

What's in this guide

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- Creating a bill and taking Cash, UPI or Credit payment
- Connecting and printing on the Bluetooth receipt printer
- Collecting credit repayments and closing the cash drawer each day
- Logging expenses, checking your canteen's budget, and the daily reports
- What common messages on screen mean, and what to do about them

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1 Welcome

This guide explains every screen and button a Cashier uses in FoodPrint, in plain language and in the order you are likely to use them in a normal working day.

FoodPrint is the canteen billing and management app you use to take payments, print receipts, track credit customers, log expenses and close the cash drawer at the end of the day. As a **Cashier**, you work on one canteen branch — the one your account is assigned to — and everything you see and create (bills, expenses, credit customers, your daily closing) belongs to that branch.

How to read this guide

Button and screen names are shown like this: **Save & Print Bill** for a button you tap, and `New Bill` for a screen title. Numbered steps are things you do in order. Boxes like this one give extra tips; orange and red boxes are warnings worth reading carefully.

Your connection matters

FoodPrint needs an internet connection to save a bill, a repayment, an expense or a cash closing — these always go straight to the server, never only to your phone. If your phone has no signal or Wi-Fi, the app will tell you a connection is needed instead of pretending the save worked. This is deliberate: it protects your money records from ever going missing silently.

2 Signing in

Your administrator creates your account and tells you your email address and a starting password.

1. Open the FoodPrint app. You will see the `Welcome Back` sign-in screen.
2. Enter your **Email Address** and **Password**. Tap the eye icon in the password box to check what you typed before submitting.
3. Tap **Sign In**. On the keyboard you can also press the "Next" key to move from email to password, and "Done" on the password field to sign in directly.
4. The app checks your account and takes you straight to your dashboard. There is no fixed waiting time — it moves on as soon as your account is confirmed.

Forgot your password?

1. On the sign-in screen, enter your email address in the **Email Address** box.
2. Tap **Forgot Password?** below the Sign In button.
3. A reset email is sent to that address. Follow the link in that email to set a new password, then come back and sign in.

If you cannot sign in

- **"Invalid email or password"** — check for typos, or use Forgot Password above.
- **"This account has been deactivated"** — your admin has switched off your account. Contact your administrator; you cannot fix this yourself.
- **"User role not found"** — your account exists in the login system but has no staff record yet. Contact your administrator.
- **"Connection Error"** — the app could not reach the server to check your account. Check your internet connection and try again; you are never let into the app on a guess.

3 Your dashboard

This is your home screen after signing in — a quick snapshot of today, and one tap away from everything else.

What you see at the top

- **Today's Revenue** and **Bills Issued** — two figures for the current business day, updated live as you bill. Tapping them opens the Daily Sales Report and All Bills History respectively. If a figure cannot be loaded it shows a dash (—), never a guessed zero.
- **Bell icon** (top right) — shows a red badge when there is an unread notice from your admin. Tap it to open `Notifications`.
- **Budget warning banner** — if your canteen's monthly budget is running low (less than 15% left) or has been exceeded, a red banner appears here explaining by how much. It disappears once the situation improves or if no budget has been set.

Create New Bill

The large blue card is the fastest way into billing — tap it any time to start a new sale. This is the single most-used action in the app.

MENU section

TILE	WHAT IT DOES
View Menu	Browse every item on your canteen's menu with its Full and Half prices — a read-only list, useful for checking prices without starting a bill.
Manage Menu	Add new items or edit existing ones (name, prices). See Section 10.

OPERATIONS section

TILE	WHAT IT DOES
All Bills	Full, searchable history of every bill made at your canteen.
Log Expense	Record a cost (vegetables, gas, groceries, maintenance, etc.) with an optional photo of the receipt.

Credit Customers	See everyone with a pending credit balance and collect repayments.
Monthly Report	Your canteen's monthly budget: how much is allocated, how much has been spent, and how much is left.

The side menu

Tap the menu icon (☰, top left) to open the **Cashier Panel** drawer, which lists: Monthly Report, Log Expense, Cash Reconciliation, All Bills History, Admin Notices, SMS Broadcast Specials, and Logout. It is simply a second way to reach the same screens described in this guide.

4 Creating a bill

This is the `New Bill` screen — the one you will use most. It is built to be fast: as few taps as possible between picking up the order and handing over a printed receipt.

Step 1 — Add items to the cart

1. Tap **Search by item code or name...** and type a few letters of the item, or its code. Matching items appear instantly.
2. Set the **quantity** with the `−` and `+` buttons next to the search box.
3. Choose `Full` or `Half` price, if the item has a half-plate price.
4. Tap `+ Add to Bill`. The item appears in the **Bill Items** list below with its line total.
5. Repeat for every item in the order. To remove a line from the cart, tap the small red delete icon on that row.

> **Checking the total**
>
> The running **Total Amount** is always shown just above the payment buttons, updated the instant you add or remove an item — no need to add it up yourself.

Step 2 — Choose how the customer is paying

Tap one of the three payment buttons: `Cash`, `UPI`, or `Credit`.

Cash or UPI

Nothing further to fill in — go straight to Step 3.

Credit

1. A **Credit Customer** box opens asking for the customer's **Name** and **Phone** number.
2. If this phone number has billed on credit before, their existing pending balance is shown.
3. Every canteen has a **₹2,000 credit limit per customer**. If this bill would push the customer's pending balance above ₹2,000, the app refuses and explains: "*Customer has a pending credit*

of ₹X. Adding this bill (₹Y) would exceed the ₹2,000 credit limit. Please collect a repayment first." In that case, collect what they owe first (Section 6) before adding more credit.

Step 3 — Save and print

1. Tap **Save & Print Bill**.
2. The bill is saved to the server first. The button shows a spinner while this happens — **do not tap it again**; a second tap while it is saving is deliberately ignored, so you can never create two bills for the same order by accident.
3. Once saved, the app sends the receipt to your connected printer automatically. If the printer is not connected, you can still find and reprint the bill later from **All Bills**.
4. The cart clears and the screen is ready for the next customer.

Leaving the screen with items in the cart

If you press Back (or swipe back) while there are items in the cart, FoodPrint asks **"Leave without saving?"** and tells you exactly how many items and what total will be discarded. Choose **Keep editing** to stay, or **Discard bill** to leave and lose the cart. With an empty cart, Back leaves straight away. While a bill is being saved, Back is blocked with "Saving the bill. Please wait a moment."

If your phone's date or time is wrong

FoodPrint checks your phone's clock against the server before saving a bill, repayment or cash closing. If your phone's date is wrong enough to land it on the wrong business day, it stops you with **"This phone's date is wrong"** and tells you nothing was saved — go to Settings > Date & time and turn on "Automatic date & time", then try again. If your phone cannot reach the internet to check, this safeguard is simply skipped and your sale proceeds as normal.

5 Connecting and using the printer

FoodPrint prints receipts on a Bluetooth thermal printer. The printer status is always visible at the top right of the billing screen.

What the status badge means

BADGE	MEANING
Connected	Ready — the next bill will print automatically.
Connecting / Scanning	The app is in the middle of pairing or opening the connection; wait a moment.
Disconnected	A printer was chosen before but is not connected right now (switched off, out of range, or just not yet reconnected).
No BT	Bluetooth is turned off on the phone.
No Printer	No printer has ever been paired with this phone in Android's Bluetooth settings.

Pairing a printer for the first time

1. Turn the thermal printer on and make sure it is in pairing mode (see the printer's own manual if needed).
2. In Android's Bluetooth settings, pair the printer with the phone once, the normal Android way.
3. Back in FoodPrint, on the billing screen, tap **Choose** next to the printer status.
4. The first time, Android will ask to let FoodPrint "find, connect to, and determine relative position of nearby devices" — allow this. It is required by Android on newer phones to use Bluetooth at all, and FoodPrint does not use it to track your location.
5. Pick your printer from the list of paired devices. The status changes to **Connecting** and then **Connected**.

Day to day

- Once paired, FoodPrint remembers the printer and reconnects automatically most of the time.

- If the badge shows **Disconnected**, tap **Reconnect** to connect to the last-used printer again, or **Choose** to pick a different one.
- If a print fails partway (for example the printer ran out of paper or was switched off), the app tells you clearly and **does not duplicate the bill** — the sale is already safely saved, only the paper receipt failed, and you can reprint once the printer is working from All Bills.

If printing was not working before and is now fixed

Some phones running Android 12 or newer previously showed a **"Connection failed: Need android.permission.BLUETOOTH_SCAN permission"** error every time you tried to connect. This has been fixed — if you still have an older version of the app, ask your administrator for the latest update, which asks for the Bluetooth permission correctly in one prompt.

6 Credit customers and repayments

Every customer who has ever been billed on Credit appears here, with how much they still owe.

Finding and viewing a customer

1. From the dashboard, open **Credit Customers**.
2. Use the search box to find a customer by name or phone number.
3. Tap a customer to open their detail page, which shows their **pending bills** and their full **repayment history** in two tabs.

Collecting a repayment

1. On the customer's detail page, open **Receive Payment**.
2. Enter the **Amount Received**.
3. Choose the **Payment Mode** (Cash or UPI).
4. Confirm. The amount is applied to the customer's oldest pending bills first, and their balance updates immediately. Tapping the button twice cannot create a duplicate repayment — the same double-tap protection used for bills applies here.

> **Why this matters for billing**
>
> A customer's pending balance is exactly what the ₹2,000 credit limit check in Section 4 compares against. Collecting a repayment here is often the quickest way to let a regular customer keep buying on credit.

7 Daily cash closing

At the end of your shift, FoodPrint asks you to count the cash drawer and compare it with what the system expects — called `Daily Cash Closing`.

Understanding "Expected Cash"

The screen shows an **Expected Cash in Register (System Total)** figure. This is the day's cash sales plus any cash repayments collected — not a guess, but the exact total the app has recorded for your canteen today. The screen will not let you submit a closing until this figure has actually loaded; if it fails to load, you will see a clear error with a **Try again** button rather than a wrong number.

Submitting your closing

1. Open **Cash Reconciliation** from the side menu.
2. Count the physical cash in the drawer and enter it under **Actual Cash in Drawer (INR)**.
3. Optionally add a note (for example, a reason for any shortage or surplus).
4. As you type, the screen shows the **Status: Balanced / Shortage / Surplus** and the exact difference, down to the paisa.
5. Tap **Submit Closing Reconciliation**.

> **One closing per day**
>
> Only one cash closing can be submitted per canteen per business day. Once submitted, the screen switches to a read-only "Reconciled for Today" summary showing who submitted it and at what time. If you try to submit again, FoodPrint tells you a reconciliation has already been submitted today.

> **If midnight passes while you have this screen open**
>
> FoodPrint automatically notices when the business day changes (around 00:00 IST) and refreshes the expected cash figure for you, with a message explaining the figures were updated — so you are never able to submit today's count against yesterday's numbers.

8 Monthly budget

Each canteen has its own monthly spending budget, set by your administrator.

1. Open **Monthly Report** from the dashboard or side menu. The title reads **Monthly Budget — [your canteen's name]**.
2. A blue card shows three figures: **Allocated Budget**, **Total Spent**, and **Available Balance**, plus a usage bar.
3. The bar turns orange when less than 15% of the budget remains, and red if the budget has been exceeded.
4. Below the card is the month's list of logged expenses.

> **"No budget set for this canteen yet"**
>
> If your admin has not entered a budget for this month, the card shows this message instead of figures. This is expected and not an error — ask your administrator to set it if you need it for planning.

9 Logging an expense

Record any cost paid out of the canteen, such as vegetables, gas or maintenance.

1. Open **Log Expense**.
2. Choose an **Expense Category**: Vegetables, Gas, Groceries, Maintenance, or Other. If you pick Other, you must also type a short **Reason for Other**.
3. Enter the **Amount (₹)**.
4. Optionally attach a photo of the receipt, from the **Camera** or your phone's **Gallery**.
5. Tap **Save Expense**.

Every expense you log counts against your canteen's monthly budget (Section 8) and appears in your admin's expense report.

10 Menu — viewing and adding items

Two screens cover the menu: a read-only browse view, and an edit screen for adding or changing items.

View Menu

Shows every item on your canteen's menu with its Full and Half price. Use this to quickly check a price while talking to a customer, without leaving the billing flow.

Manage Menu — All Items tab

A searchable list of every item, with its code, name, cost price, Full price, and Half price (if any). Tap the pencil icon on any item to edit it.

Manage Menu — Add / Edit tab

1. Fill in an **Item Code *** (a short unique ID, e.g. "CH01") and **Item Name *** (e.g. "Chicken Biryani").
2. Enter the **Cost Price** and **Full Price**. A **Half Price** is optional.
3. Tap **Save Item** (or **Update Item** when editing). When editing, the item code cannot be changed.

> **Deleting a menu item**
>
> Only an administrator can delete a menu item — this is a deliberate safety rule, so a menu item cannot be accidentally removed by a cashier mid-shift. If you need an item removed, ask your admin.

11 Reports

Three screens let you check your canteen's sales history at different levels of detail.

SCREEN	SHOWS
Today's Sales	Every bill made today at your canteen, with a running total split by Cash, UPI and Credit.
Daily Sales Report	The same summary for any single date you pick, using the date-picker at the top of the screen.
All Bills History	Every bill ever made at your canteen, searchable and browsable month by month. Tap any bill to see its full receipt detail.

12 Notices from admin

Your administrator can send announcements to all staff, such as a menu change or a reminder.

A new notice shows a pop-up alert the first time you see it, and the bell icon on your dashboard carries an unread badge until you have read it. Open **Admin Notices** (bell icon, or side menu) to see the full list and read any notice in full.

13 SMS Broadcast Specials

This feature is listed in the side menu but is not built yet.

Tapping **SMS Broadcast Specials** shows a **"Coming soon"** message. There is nothing to set up or troubleshoot here — it will be announced when it is ready.

14 Signing out

1. Open the side menu (☰) and tap **Logout** at the bottom, below the divider.

2. You are returned to the sign-in screen. Any bill you had not yet saved is not kept — always finish or discard a bill before signing out.

15 Troubleshooting & common messages

FoodPrint is built to explain problems in plain language rather than leave you guessing. Here is what the most common messages mean.

YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS / WHAT TO DO
"Could not load — This screen needs a one-time database setup that is not finished yet. Please tell the admin."	A one-time setup step on the server has not been completed. Tell your administrator; it is nothing you can fix from the app, and no data has been lost.
"Could not load — Cannot reach the server. Check the internet connection and try again."	Your phone has no usable internet connection right now. Check Wi-Fi or mobile data and tap **Try again**.
"Could not load — You do not have access to this information"	Your account does not have permission for this screen or action. Ask your administrator to check your account.
"Still loading. Check your internet connection."	A screen has been loading for more than a few seconds, usually a sign of a weak connection.
A spinner that appears after Save & Print Bill	Normal — the bill is being saved to the server. Wait for it; do not tap again.
"Add at least one item first."	You tried to save an empty bill. Add at least one item to the cart first.
Printer shows Disconnected	Tap Reconnect, or see Section 5.

A good rule of thumb

If something fails to save, FoodPrint will always say so clearly — it never shows a false "success" message for a bill, repayment, expense or cash closing that did not actually reach the server. If you ever see a plain error message you don't understand, the safest next step is always the same: check your internet connection, tap Try again if offered, and if it still fails, tell your administrator exactly what the message said.

16 Quick reference card

A one-page summary you can glance at during a busy shift.

Make a sale

- Search item → set qty/Full-Half → Add to Bill
- Repeat for every item
- Pick Cash / UPI / Credit
- Credit: enter name + phone
- Tap Save & Print Bill once, then wait

Printer

- Connected = ready to print
- Disconnected → tap Reconnect
- No Printer → tap Choose, pick from list
- First time: allow the Bluetooth permission prompt

Credit customers

- ₹2,000 pending limit per customer
- Collect a repayment to free up room
- Oldest bills are paid off first

End of day

- Count the drawer
- Cash Reconciliation → enter actual cash
- Submit once — only one closing per day

Something went wrong

- Read the message on screen — it explains itself
- Check your internet connection
- Try again if offered
- Still stuck → tell your administrator

Remember

- Nothing saves without an internet connection
- A double-tap never creates a duplicate
- Only an admin can delete a menu item
